DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

What Bekhorot is really about

Jev score: 0.44 — Jev score: does the Introduction to Bekhorot illuminate the daf non-obviously?

The tractate introduction frames Bekhorot as the laws of firstborns in all their kinds — human, animal, and the ramifying details. Against that backdrop, today's daf looks like a study in the tractate's outer edge: it asks what happens when the 'firstborn' never quite becomes one. A miscarried fetus, an expelled mass, a womb that opens on something unformed — the daf keeps testing whether these count as offspring at all, and the answer keeps turning on thresholds: is the head the size of a skein of yarn, is the fetus nullified in the majority, does the afterbirth imply a child within?

What the introduction quietly contributes is the sense that Bekhorot's real subject is not the firstborn but the boundary of the category — who and what gets counted. The daf's impurity debates are the same question wearing different clothes: the line between potential and actual life, drawn with a skein of wool.

PARSHA · BERESHIT

Drawing the line between the undefined and the defined

Jev score: 0.67 — Jev score: how strongly is the boundary-drawing connection grounded in both texts?

Bereshit opens with separation as the first creative act — light from darkness, waters above from waters below, each division named and declared good. Bekhorot 22 is doing the same work in miniature: the daf draws line after line around the undefined. A mass is expelled — is it an offspring? A fetus dissolves into the majority — does it still transmit impurity? The head must be the size of a skein of yarn before the womb's opening counts. In both texts, reality arrives only once the boundary is drawn and named.

The parallel runs deeper than analogy. Creation's divisions are pronounced — 'and God called' — and the daf's thresholds are likewise performative: burying the mass 'to publicize' the exemption, the sages' formal nullification. In both, the undefined becomes defined not by nature alone but by an act of determination.

Rejected by Jev: nullification/mass parallel (0.19), measurement-as-religious-act (0.29), publicizing the exemption (0.19), birth-impurity intersection (0.38), offspring-generations (0.52)

NEWS CHECK

No genuine link this week

Jev score: 0.21 — Jev score: highest of 8 proposed news links; strict bar applied

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Eight stories were tested against the daf's themes — fetal thresholds, nullification, precise halakhic measurement — and Jev rejected every one, the best reaching only 0.21. The Bondi shooting's legislative aftermath, the Taiwan arms deal, the AI bank hack: each proposed link turned out to share a word or a mood with the daf rather than a genuine resonance. A forced connection is worse than none, so this section reports the negative result plainly.

MAAGARIM · UBBAR

עובר: the one passing through

The daf's load-bearing noun is עובר — the fetus, the offspring whose status decides everything: firstborn exemption, corpse-impurity, whether the afterbirth implies a child. The root is ע-ב-ר, to pass over, to cross. The fetus is literally 'the one passing through' — named not for what it is but for the transit it is undergoing, the crossing from inside to outside that the whole daf is trying to pin down. Its earliest biblical appearance is already a legal threshold case: Exodus 21:22, the miscarriage caused by men fighting, where the law must decide what was lost. From there it becomes the rabbinic technical term for the unborn child, carrying the same question across two millennia: at what point in the passage does the passer count?

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Sweep partial this edition (direct lookup unavailable); attestation from Sefaria texts.

929 · I KINGS 3 (CH. 290)

Ask for a hearing heart

Chapters 1–2 of Kings were the succession — David's death, Adonijah's bid, Solomon's consolidation ending in Shimei's execution. Chapter 3 opens the reign proper, and it opens in three movements: the alliance (3:1), the theophany (3:5–15), and the demonstration (3:16–28). The whole chapter is about how wisdom arrives and how it proves itself.

The first movement is the most awkward: 'ויתחתן שלמה את פרעה' — Solomon marries Pharaoh's daughter. Rashi, following the midrash, dates it with precision: all the time Shimei his teacher was alive, Solomon did not marry her, 'מכאן אמרו: לעולם ידור אדם במקום רבו' — from here they said: a man should always dwell where his teacher dwells. Ralbag is blunter about the legal residue: the marriage came after her conversion, but 'מדרכי התורה היה בזה הענין יציאה קצת' — there was in this matter a slight departure from the Torah's ways, since Egyptians enter the congregation only in the third generation. Malbim reads it as statecraft: having secured the kingdom within, Solomon secured it against the surrounding kings by alliance with a great power. Three commentators, three registers — aggadah, halakhah, politics — on a single verse.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Then Gibeon. אלקים appears to Solomon in a dream: 'שאל מה אתן לך' — ask what I shall give you. Solomon asks for 'לב שמע לשפט את עמך' — a hearing heart to judge Your people. Rashi hears the weight in עמך הכבד: a people is 'heavy' because they have many affairs and come to judgment, and he adds the terrifying corollary — if a judge takes from one gentile litigant and gives to another wrongly, he is not punished; but for Israel, 'הריני נענש עליו עונש נפשות' — I am punished with the punishment of souls. Metzudat David puts it plainly: it is impossible to judge such a people from the wisdom of one's own heart without help from heaven. The request itself is the first act of wisdom: knowing that judgment needs more than intellect.

The answer is famous — 'לב חכם ונבון,' a wise and discerning heart — but the commentators refuse to let it stay a slogan. Radak cites the sages: חכם is one who retains his learning ('למודו'), נבון is one who understands one thing from another. And 'אשר כמוך לא היה לפניך' — Radak records two readings: even Moses did not equal him in חכמת הטבע (though in divine wisdom Moses was greater), or simply: among kings. Malbim builds the gift's architecture verse by verse: the wisdom to hear judgment that he asked for, plus universal wisdom — natural, political, divine — that he did not ask for, and with it wealth and honor as wisdom's necessary accompaniments ('גם עשר גם כבוד'), while long life alone is conditional: 'אם תלך בדרכי.' Wisdom is a package; longevity is a covenant.

The third movement is the proof. Radak on 'אז תבאנה' (3:16) insists on the אז: this case came to Solomon as he returned from Gibeon to Jerusalem — the first display of the gift, the receipt for the dream. Ralbag demythologizes the two women: they were probably innkeepers, like Rahab the זונה, and Solomon's gambit was to frighten them so that the truth would surface from their own mouths — 'אשר תחמול יותר על הבן החי יתבאר בלי ספק שהיא אמו' — the one who has more compassion on the living child is unmistakably the mother.

The judgment's literary pivot is the order of the women's words. Malbim on 3:27: Solomon 'להכריע מתוך סדר דבריהם מי החפץ בילד ומי לא' — decided from the order of their words who wanted the child and who did not. The true mother says 'תנו לה את הילוד החי' — give her the living child — and Rashi adds the midrashic seal: a בת קול emerged and said 'היא אמו.' Radak and Metzudat David agree on the plain-sense reading: 'הואיל ומרחמת עליו' — because she had compassion on him.

Notice the thread the chapter sews: לב — heart — appears in the request (לב שמע), in the grant (לב חכם ונבון), and the whole episode is framed by שמע, hearing. Solomon asks to hear, is given a hearing heart, and the proof is that he hears which voice loves the child. The dream is given in sleep; the wisdom is proven awake. The same Gibeon theophany is told in Chronicles (2 Chr 1), where the emphasis falls on the place — the great high place — rather than the night-dream intimacy Kings preserves.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 9:7-8

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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The beehive in the doorway

Oholot 9:7

בַּמֶּה דְבָרִים אֲמוּרִים, בִּזְמַן שֶׁהִיא כְלִי מְחֻלְחֶלֶת. הָיְתָה פְחוּתָה וּפְקוּקָה בְקַשׁ אוֹ אֲפוּצָה, אֵיזוֹהִי אֲפוּצָה, כֹּל שֶׁאֵין לָהּ טֶפַח מִמָּקוֹם אֶחָד, כַּזַּיִת מִן הַמֵּת נָתוּן תַּחְתֶּיהָ, כְּנֶגְדּוֹ עַד הַתְּהוֹם טָמֵא. עַל גַּבָּהּ, כְּנֶגְדּוֹ עַד הָרָקִיעַ טָמֵא. בְּתוֹכָהּ אוֹ בַבַּיִת, תּוֹכָהּ וְהַבַּיִת טְמֵאִים:

When do these rules apply? When the hive is a vessel and it is loosely placed in the door. If it is defective, although [it may be] stopped up with straw or it is stuck to the side of the door What is "stuck? Anything which has no opening of one handbreadth : Then, if an olive-sized [portion] of a corpse is placed below it, [everything] directly [below the portion] to the depths becomes unclean; [If placed] above [the hive everything] directly above to the sky becomes unclean. [If the uncleanness is] in the house or in the hive, whatever is in the house or hive becomes unclean.

Rambam: כבר ביארנו שתוכה ותוך הבית דינם אחד מפני היות פיה בתוך הבית — *we have already explained that the hive's interior and the house's interior are one, since its mouth is inside the house.*

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: This mishnah parallels mishnah 3, but there the hive's mouth faced outward and here it faces inward; it also parallels mishnah 5, but there the hive was loosely placed (מחולחלת) and here it is sealed shut (אפוצה). The laws were presented in a table.

Oholot 9:8

הָיְתָה גְבוֹהָה מִן הָאָרֶץ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה תַחְתֶּיהָ אוֹ בַבַּיִת אוֹ בְתוֹכָהּ, הַכֹּל טָמֵא, אֶלָּא גַּבָּהּ. עַל גַּבָּהּ, כְּנֶגְדּוֹ עַד הָרָקִיעַ טָמֵא:

[In the case of such a hive] being [placed] one handbreadth high off the ground:If there is uncleanness below it, in the house or inside the hive everything is impure except for above it. If above [the hive] what is directly above up to the sky becomes unclean.

Rambam: כאשר היתה אפוצה הנה היא כמו חתיכה מן הארץ — *when the hive is sealed shut it is like a piece of the ground itself; impurity opposite it rises to the sky, while its top stays pure since the impurity exits through its mouth into the house.*

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Parallels mishnah 4 (mouth outward) but here the mouth faces inward; like mishnah 7 it treats a sealed hive, but there the hive sat on the ground while here it is raised a handbreadth, forming a tent beneath it. Impurity below spreads by tent-law into the house and the hive — everything impure except the hive's top.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT YIBBUM VACHALITZAH 6

Who is fit for yibbum, who is not

Halachah 1

יֵשׁ אַחִין שֶׁרְאוּיִין לְיִבּוּם אוֹ לַחֲלִיצָה. וְיֵשׁ אַחִין שֶׁאֵינָן רְאוּיִין לֹא לְיִבּוּם וְלֹא לַחֲלִיצָה וְאֵין לָהֶן זִקָּה

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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כְּלָל אֶלָּא יְבִמְתּוֹ מֻתֶּרֶת לָזָּר. וְיֵשׁ אַחִין שֶׁרְאוּיִין לַחֲלִיצָה וְאֵינָן רְאוּיִין לְיִבּוּם. וְיֵשׁ אַחִין שֶׁהֵן רְאוּיִין לְיִבּוּם וְאֵינָן רְאוּיִין לַחֲלִיצָה:

There are brothers who are fit to perform either the rite of yibbum or the rite of chalitzah. There are brothers who are not fit to perform either the rite of yibbum or the rite of chalitzah. [The deceased's wives] are under no obligation to them at all; they may marry another man. There are brothers who are fit to perform the rite of chalitzah but not the rite of yibbum, and there are brothers who are fit to perform the rite of yibbum but not the rite of chalitzah.

Halachah 2

וְאֵלּוּ הֵם שֶׁאֵין לָהֶן זִקָּה כְּלָל. סְרִיס חַמָּה וַאֲנְדְּרוֹגִינוּס מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵינָן רְאוּיִין לֵילֵד וְלֹא הָיָה לָהֶן שְׁעַת הַכּשֶׁר:

With regard to the following, [the deceased's wives] have no obligation at all: a saris chamah and an androgynous, for they are not fit to father children, nor had they been at any time.

Halachah 3

וְאֵלּוּ מְיַבְּמִין וְלֹא חוֹלְצִין. הַחֵרֵשׁ וְהַשּׁוֹטֶה וְהַקָּטָן מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵין בָּהֶן דַּעַת לַחֲלֹץ. וּכְשֶׁיְּבַם הַחֵרֵשׁ אֵינוֹ מוֹצִיא לְעוֹלָם שֶׁבְּעִילָתוֹ עוֹשָׂה אוֹתָהּ אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ גְּמוּרָה וְאֵין גֵּרוּשָׁיו גֵּרוּשִׁין גְּמוּרִין. וּבֶן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁיְּבַם אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לְגָרֵשׁ עַד שֶׁיַּגְדִּיל כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ:

These are [the brothers] who are fit to perform the rite of yibbum, but not the rite of chalitzah: a deaf-mute, a mentally incompetent man and a minor. [The rationale is that] they lack the mental competence to perform chalitzah. When a deaf-mute performs yibbum, he may never divorce [his yevamah]. For by entering into relations with her, he establishes a marriage bond that is completely binding, and he is incapable of divorcing a woman in a completely effective manner. [When a yavam who is below the age of majority but more than] nine years and one day old performs yibbum, [he acquires his yevamah as a wife]. He may not, however, divorce [her] until he attains majority, as we have explained.

Halachah 4

וְאֵלּוּ חוֹלְצִין וְלֹא מְיַבְּמִין. הַסְּפֵקוֹת כְּגוֹן שֶׁהָיְתָה סְפֵק עֶרְוָה עַל אָחִיו. וּפְצוּעַ דַּכָּא וּכְרוּת שָׁפְכָה וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָּהֶן מִמִּינֵי הַסָּרוּס. וְהַזָּקֵן בְּיוֹתֵר שֶׁתְּשַׁשׁ כֹּחוֹ וְכָשַׁל. וְאִם בָּעַל סְרִיס אָדָם קָנָה שֶׁהֲרֵי הָיְתָה לוֹ שְׁעַת הַכּשֶׁר וּמוֹצִיא בְּגֵט מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא אָסוּר לָבוֹא בַּקָּהָל. וְהַטֻּמְטוּם חוֹלֵץ וְלֹא מְיַבֵּם מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא סָפֵק. וְאִם נִקְרַע וְנִמְצָא זָכָר רָצָה חוֹלֵץ רָצָה מְיַבֵּם. וּשְׁאָר הָאַחִין אוֹ חוֹלְצִין אוֹ מְיַבְּמִין:

These are [the brothers] who are fit to perform the rite of chalitzah, but not the rite of yibbum: those whose status is in doubt - e.g., there is a doubt whether a yevamah is

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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forbidden to [the deceased's] brother, a man with crushed testicles, or a crushed member, or who has been castrated in any other way, and an elderly man whose virility has been weakened and he is incapable. If [a yavam] who has been castrated enters into relations [with his yevamah], he acquires [her as a wife], for there was a time when he was sexually potent. He must, however, divorce her with a get, because he is forbidden to marry [a native-born Jewess]. A tumtum should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum, because his status is one of doubt. If an operation is performed, and it is revealed that he is a male, he may perform either chalitzah or yibbum, as he desires. Brothers [of the deceased who are not in any of the categories listed above] may perform either chalitzah or yibbum.

Halachah 5

יֵשׁ יְבָמוֹת שֶׁהֵן רְאוּיוֹת לַחֲלִיצָה אוֹ לְיִבּוּם. וְיֵשׁ יְבָמוֹת שֶׁאֵינָן רְאוּיוֹת לֹא לַחֲלִיצָה וְלֹא לְיִבּוּם וְאֵין עֲלֵיהֶן זְקָה כְּלָל וּמֻתָּרוֹת לְהִנָּשֵׂא לְזָר. וְיֵשׁ יְבָמוֹת שֶׁהֵן רְאוּיוֹת לַחֲלִיצָה אֲבָל לֹא לְיִבּוּם. וְיֵשׁ יְבָמוֹת שֶׁהֵן רְאוּיוֹת לְיִבּוּם אֲבָל לֹא לַחֲלִיצָה:

There are yevamot who are fit to perform either the rite of chalitzah or the rite of yibbum. There are yevamot who are not fit to perform either the rite of yibbum or the rite of chalitzah. They are under no obligation to [the deceased's brothers] at all, and they may marry another man. There are yevamot who are fit to perform the rite of chalitzah, but not the rite of yibbum, and there are yevamot who are fit to perform the rite of yibbum but not the rite of chalitzah.

Halachah 6

וְאֵלּוּ שֶׁמִּתְיַבְּמוֹת וְלֹא חוֹלְצוֹת. הַחֵרֶשֶׁת וְהַשּׁוֹטָה וְהַקְּטַנָּה לְפִי שֶׁאֵין בָּהֶן דַּעַת לִקְרוֹת וּלְהָבִין. וְאִם רָצָה הַיָּבָם לְגָרֵשׁ הַחֵרֶשֶׁת בְּגֵט אַחַר שֶׁיִּבְעל אוֹתָהּ הֲרֵי זֶה מְגָרֵשׁ:

These are [the yevamot] who may perform the rite of yibbum, but not the rite of chalitzah: a deaf-mute, a mentally incompetent woman and a minor. [The rationale why they cannot perform chalitzah is that] they lack the mental competence to read and to understand. If the yavam desires to divorce the deaf-mute with a get after he engages in relations with her, he may.

Halachah 7

וְאֵלּוּ שֶׁחוֹלְצוֹת וְלֹא מִתְיַבְּמוֹת. אִסּוּרֵי לָאוִין וְהַשְּׁנִיּוֹת וְאִסּוּרֵי עֲשֵׂה כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר. וְכָל אִשָּׁה שֶׁהִיא סְפֵק מְגֹרֶשֶׁת חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת שֶׁמָּא יִפְגַּע בְּעֶרְוָה. שֶׁאֵשֶׁת אָחִיו שֶׁגֵּרְשָׁהּ אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו מִשּׁוּם עֶרְוָה. אֲבָל מִי שֶׁהִיא מְקֻדֶּשֶׁת לְאָחִיו בְּסָפֵק קִדּוּשִׁין הֲרֵי הִיא כִּשְׁאָר כָּל הַיְבָמוֹת וְחוֹלֶצֶת אוֹ מִתְיַבֶּמֶת שֶׁאֵין כָּאן דָּבָר לָחוּשׁ לוֹ. וְכֵן אֵשֶׁת הַחֵרֵשׁ וּזְקֵנָה וַעֲקָרָה הֲרֵי הֵן כִּשְׁאָר כָּל הַיְבָמוֹת. רָצָה חוֹלֵץ רָצָה מְיַבֵּם. שֶׁזְּקֵנָה וַעֲקָרָה הָיְתָה לָהֶן שְׁעַת הַכּשֶׁר:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

These are [the yevamot] who may perform the rite of chalitzah, but not the rite of yibbum: [Women who are] forbidden [to the yavam] because of a negative commandment, [because of a Rabbinic ordinance - i.e.,] sh'niyot, or because of a positive commandment, as will be explained. Whenever there is a doubt whether or not a woman was divorced [by the deceased], she should perform chalitzah and not yibbum, lest the yavam violate a prohibition. For a brother's wife who was divorced is forbidden as an ervah. If, however, there was a doubt regarding whether a woman was consecrated to one's [deceased] brother, her status is like that of another yevamah, and she may perform either chalitzah or yibbum. For there is no possibility of [a prohibition being involved]. Similarly, the wife of a deaf-mute, an elderly woman or a woman who has become barren are like other yevamot. The yavam may perform either chalitzah or yibbum, as he desires. [The rationale is that] the elderly woman and the woman who has become barren were once fit [to bear children].

Halachah 8

וְאֵלּוּ הֵן שֶׁהֵן פְּטוּרוֹת מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם. אֵשֶׁת סְרִיס חַמָּה וְאַנְדְּרוֹגִינוּס וְאֵשֶׁת הַשּׁוֹטֶה וְאֵשֶׁת הַקָּטָן וְאַיְלוֹנִית וּמִי שֶׁהִיא עֶרְוָה. שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כה ו) ”וְלֹא יִמְחֶה שְׁמוֹ מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל“ פָּרַט לִסְרִיס חַמָּה וְאַנְדְּרוֹגִינוּס שֶׁשְּׁמָם מָחוּי הוֹאִיל וְאֵינָן רְאוּיִין לְיַלֵּד מִתְּחִלַּת בְּרִיָּתָן הֲרֵי הֵן כְּמִין בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ. (דברים כה ו) ”וְהָיָה הַבְּכוֹר אֲשֶׁר תֵּלֵד“ פָּרַט לְאַיְלוֹנִית שֶׁאֵינָהּ רְאוּיָה לְיַלֵּד מִתְּחִלַּת בְּרִיָּתָהּ. (דברים כה ה) ”לֹא תִהְיֶה אֵשֶׁת הַמֵּת“ פָּרַט לְאֵשֶׁת שׁוֹטֶה וְקָטָן מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם אֵישׁוּת כְּלָל. (דברים כה ה) ”וּלְקָחָהּ לוֹ לְאִשָּׁה“ פָּרַט לְעֶרְוָה שֶׁאֵין לוֹ בָּהּ לִקּוּחִין:

The following are not obligated to perform either chalitzah or yibbum: the wife of a saris chamah or the wife of an androgynous, the wife of a mentally incompetent person or the wife of a minor, an aylonit, or a woman forbidden [to her yavam] as one of the arayot. [The rationale for these laws is as follows. Deuteronomy 25:6 states that yibbum was instituted:] "So that the name of [the deceased] not be obliterated within Israel." This excludes the wife of a saris chamah or the wife of an androgynous, for their names are "obliterated" by nature. Since they are inherently unfit to father children, they are considered to be a separate category. [The verse continues:] "And the firstborn that she bears." This excludes an aylonit, who is, by nature, incapable of bearing a child. It is written [ibid:5]: "The wife of the deceased...." This excludes the wife of a mentally incompetent person or the wife of a minor - for with regard to them, there is no concept of marriage at all. [The verse continues:] "And he will take her as a wife." This excludes a woman forbidden [to her yavam] as one of the arayot, for she cannot be taken as a wife.

Halachah 9

כֵּיצַד. יְבָמָה שֶׁהִיא עֶרְוָה עַל יְבָמָהּ כְּגוֹן שֶׁהָיְתָה אֲחוֹת אִשְׁתּוֹ אוֹ אִמָּהּ אוֹ בִּתָּהּ הֲרֵי זוֹ פְּטוּרָה מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם וְאֵין לוֹ עָלֶיהָ זִקָּה כְּלָל שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כה ה) ”וּלְקָחָהּ לוֹ לְאִשָּׁה וְיִבְּמָהּ“. מִי

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PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

שֶׁרְאוּיָה לְלִקּוּחִין וְקִדּוּשִׁין תּוֹפְסִין בָּהּ הֵיא זְקוּקָה לְיָבָם:

How is it possible for a woman to be forbidden [to her yavam] as one of the arayot? For example, [the yevamah] was the sister, the mother, or the daughter of [the yavam's] wife. Such a woman is not obligated to perform either chalitzah or yibbum at all and is under no obligation to [the yavam], as implied by the verse: "And he shall take her as a wife, thus performing yibbum." Only a woman who is fit to be married, and whose consecration [by the yavam] is binding is obligated to perform yibbum.

Halachah IO

הָיְתָה הַיְבָמָה אֱסוּרָה עַל יְבָמָהּ אִסּוּר לָאו אוֹ אִסּוּר עֲשֵׂה אוֹ שֶׁהָיְתָה שְׁנִיָּה הֲרֵי זוֹ חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וּמִפְּנֵי מָה צְרִיכָה חֲלִיצָה מִפְּנֵי שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ לִקּוּחִין הוֹאִיל וְקִדּוּשִׁין תּוֹפְסִין בָּהֶן הֲרֵי הֵן זְקוּקוֹת לְיָבָם. וּמִן הַדִּין הָיָה שֶׁיִּתְיַבְּמוּ שֶׁהַיִּבּוּם מִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה וְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁאַתָּה מוֹצֵא עֲשֵׂה וְלֹא תַּעֲשֶׂה יָבֹא עֲשֵׂה וְיִדָּחֶה אֶת לֹא תַּעֲשֶׂה. אֲבָל חֲכָמִים גָּזְרוּ שֶׁלֹּא יִתְיַבְּמוּ חַיָּבֵי לָאוִין וְלֹא שְׁנִיּוֹת גְּזֵרָה שֶׁמָּא יָבוֹא עָלֶיהָ פַּעַם שְׁנִיָּה וַהֲרֵי בִּיאָתָהּ אֲסוּרָה וְאֵין שָׁם מִצְוָה שֶׁאֵין מִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה אֶלָּא בִּיאָה רִאשׁוֹנָה בִּלְבַד. לְפִיכָךְ אִם עָבַר וּבָעַל יְבִמְתּוֹ הָאֲסוּרָה לוֹ מִשּׁוּם לָאו אוֹ מִשּׁוּם עֲשֵׂה וְאֵין צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר שְׁנִיָּה הֲרֵי זֶה קָנָה קִנְיַן גָּמוּר וּמוֹצִיאָהּ בְּגֵט וְהִיא וְכָל צָרוֹתֶיהָ מֻתָּרוֹת לְזָר שֶׁהֲרֵי נִפְטְרוּ:

If the yevamah was forbidden to her yavam because of a negative commandment or a positive commandment, or she was one of the sh'niyot, she should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum. Why is she obligated to perform chalitzah? Because she is fit to be married, and her consecration [by the yavam] would be binding. Therefore, she is under obligation to the yavam. And according to law, she should perform yibbum, for yibbum is a positive commandment, and whenever the observance of a positive commandment conflicts with the observance of a negative commandment, the positive commandment takes precedence. Nevertheless, our Sages decreed that neither woman with whom relations are prohibited by a negative commandment, nor sh'niyot should perform yibbum, lest [the yavam] engage in relations with her a second time. [At that time,] relations with her are forbidden, and there is no mitzvah, for the positive commandment [of yibbum] applies only with regard to the first time [the couple] engage in relations. Therefore, if [the yavam] transgresses and engages in relations with a yevamah who is forbidden to him because of a negative commandment or because of a positive commandment, he acquires her [as his wife] in definitive manner and must divorce her with a get. Needless to say, [this ruling applies] with regard to a sh'niyah. [After the divorce, the yevamah] and all the other wives [of the deceased] are permitted to marry other men, for they have been released of their obligation.

Halachah II

וְיָבָמָה שֶׁהִיא אַלְמָנָה מִן הַנִּשּׂוּאִין וּבָא עָלֶיהָ כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל לֹא נִפְטְרָה צָרָתָהּ שֶׁאֵין עֲשֵׂה דּוֹחֶה אֶת לֹא

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

תַּעֲשֶׂה וַעֲשֶׂה. וְהוֹאִיל וְלֹא קָנָה מִן הַתּוֹרָה קִנְיַן גָּמוּר לֹא הֶתִּירָה צָרָתָהּ לְזָר עַד שֶׁתַּחֲלֹץ:

When a yevamah has been widowed after her marriage [to the deceased] had been consummated, and a High Priest performs yibbum with her, the other wives [of the deceased] are not released from their obligation. [The rationale is that a positive commandment does not supersede a negative commandment and a positive commandment. [Therefore,] he does not acquire [the yevamah as a wife] in a definitive manner, and as such, another wife [of the deceased] is not permitted to marry another man until she performs chalitzah [herself].

Halachah 12

הָיְתָה הַיְבָמָה עֶרְוָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ. כְּגוֹן שֶׁעָבַר אוֹ טָעָה וְלָקַח אֲחוֹתוֹ מֵאָבִיו וְנָפְלָה לִפְנֵי אָחִיו. אֵין זוֹ אִשְׁתּוֹ שֶׁאֵין קִדּוּשִׁין תּוֹפְסִין בָּהּ וְאֵינָהּ לֹא בַּת יִבּוּם וְלֹא בַּת חֲלִיצָה. וְאִם הָיְתָה לָהּ צָרָה חוֹלֶצֶת [אוֹ] מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וְאִם הָיְתָה זוֹ שֶׁהִיא עֶרְוָה עַל הַבַּעַל מֻתֶּרֶת לַיָּבָם וְרָצָה הַיָּבָם לִשָּׂא אוֹתָהּ וּלְיַבֵּם צָרָתָהּ הָרְשׁוּת בְּיָדוֹ:

[The following principle applies when] a yevamah was forbidden to her [deceased] husband as one of the arayot - e.g., he transgressed or he erred and married his paternal sister, and she is now under obligation to his brother. She is not considered to be [the deceased's] wife, for his consecration of her is not binding. [As such,] she is neither obligated to perform yibbum nor chalitzah. If [the deceased] had another wife, the other wife must perform either chalitzah or yibbum. If the woman who was forbidden to her [deceased] husband as one of the arayot is permitted to the yavam, and the yavam desires to marry her and also to perform yibbum with another wife [of the deceased], he has that option.

Halachah 13

הָיְתָה הַיְבָמָה אֲסוּרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ מִשּׁוּם לָאו אוֹ מִשּׁוּם עֲשֵׂה אוֹ שֶׁהָיְתָה שְׁנִיָּה לַבַּעַל וְלֹא הָיְתָה אֲסוּרָה עַל הַיָּבָם מִצַּד אֵלּוּ הַצְּדָדִים הֲרֵי זוֹ מֻתֶּרֶת לַיָּבָם. חוּץ מִמַּחֲזִיר גְּרוּשָׁתוֹ מִשֶּׁנִּשֵּׂאת וּמֵת שֶׁהִיא חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וְכֵן יְבָמָה שֶׁהִיא סְפֵק עֶרְוָה עַל הַיָּבָם אוֹ סְפֵק עֶרְוָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ הֲרֵי זוֹ חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. לְפִיכָךְ מִי שֶׁקִּדֵּשׁ אִשָּׁה בְּסְפֵק קִדּוּשִׁין וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵת אָחִיו שֶׁהָיְתָה נוֹשֵׂא אֲחוֹתָהּ וְנָפְלָה לוֹ לְיִבּוּם שֶׁהִיא סְפֵק אֲחוֹת אִשְׁתּוֹ הֲרֵי זוֹ חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וּמוֹצִיא אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ בְּגֵט מְסֻפֵּק וּשְׁתֵּיהֶן אֲסוּרוֹת עָלָיו. יְבִמְתּוֹ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִיא סְפֵק עֶרְוָה וַאֲרוּסָתוֹ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִיא סְפֵק קְרוֹבַת חֲלוּצָתוֹ שֶׁהִיא כִּשְׁנִיָּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ:

When a yevamah is forbidden to her husband because of a negative commandment or a positive commandment, or she is a sh'niyah with regard to him, but is not forbidden to the yavam for these reasons, she is permitted to perform yibbum. There is one exception - when the deceased remarried his divorcee after she had married another man. She should

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perform chalitzah and not yibbum. Similarly, when there is a doubt whether a yevamah was forbidden to her [deceased] husband as one of the arayot, or there is a doubt whether she is forbidden to her yavam for that reason, she should perform chalitzah and not yibbum. On this basis, [the following rules apply when] a man [attempted to] consecrate a woman, but there was a doubt regarding the status of the kiddushin, and afterwards, his brother, who had been married to the sister [of the woman he intended to consecrate], died. He should perform chalitzah and not yibbum with the wife [of the deceased]. And because of the doubt, he must divorce his wife with a get. Both women are forbidden to him: his yevamah because there is a doubt whether she is an ervah, and the woman he consecrated because there is a doubt whether her status is that of one related to a woman with whom he performed chalitzah, who is forbidden as a sh'niyah is, as explained above.

Halachah 14

מִי שֶׁמֵּת אָחִיו וְהִנִּיחַ שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים הָאַחַת אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו מִשּׁוּם עֶרְוָה וְהַשְּׁנִיָּה אֵינָהּ עֶרְוָה. כְּשֵׁם שֶׁהָעֶרְוָה פְּטוּרָה מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם כָּךְ צָרָתָהּ פְּטוּרָה וְלֹא נָפְלָה לוֹ זִקָּה כְּלָל עַל בַּיִת זֶה. שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כה ט) "אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִבְנֶה אֶת בֵּית אָחִיו" בַּיִת שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ לְקוּחִין בְּאֵי זֶה מֵהֶן שֶׁיִּרְצֶה הוּא שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ עָלָיו זִקָּה. וּבַיִת שֶׁמִּקְצָתוֹ אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לִבְנוֹתוֹ שֶׁהֲרֵי אֵין לוֹ בָּהּ לְקוּחִין אֵינוֹ בּוֹנֶה אֲפִלּוּ מִקְצָתוֹ שֶׁהוּא מֻתָּר. וְנִמְצֵאת צָרַת הָעֶרְוָה עֶרְוָה עָלָיו מִשּׁוּם אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו שֶׁהֲרֵי אֵין לוֹ עָלֶיהָ זִקָּה:

[The following principle applies when a man's] brother dies [childless] leaving two wives: one forbidden to [the yavam] as an ervah, and one who is not forbidden in this manner. Just as the woman who is forbidden is not under the obligation to perform chalitzah or yibbum, so too, [the deceased's] other wives are not obligated. This household is not under any obligation [to the yavam], as our Sages derived from [Deuteronomy 25:9]: "...Who did not build his brother's house": [Women from] a household from which he can take [any wife] he desires is under obligation [to the yavam]. But if he cannot "build" a portion of the household - i.e., he is forbidden to marry the woman - he should not "build" even the portion that is permitted to him. Thus, [when one of the wives of the deceased] is forbidden to [the yavam] as an ervah, the other wife also remains forbidden to him as an ervah. [She is still forbidden as] his brother's wife, for she is not under any obligation at all to him.

Halachah 15

לְפִיכָךְ רְאוּבֵן שֶׁמֵּת וְהִנִּיחַ שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים הָאַחַת עֶרְוָה עַל שִׁמְעוֹן וּשְׁתֵּיהֶן רְאוּיוֹת לְלֵוִי אֵין לְשִׁמְעוֹן זִקָּה עַל בַּיִת זֶה וַהֲרֵי שְׁתֵּיהֶן תַּחַת זִקַּת לֵוִי. יָבֵם לֵוִי הָאַחַת מֵהֶן שֶׁהִיא צָרַת עֶרְוָה שֶׁל שִׁמְעוֹן וְהָיְתָה לוֹ אִשָּׁה אַחֶרֶת וּמֵת לֵוִי וְנָפְלוּ שְׁתֵּיהֶן לִפְנֵי שִׁמְעוֹן שְׁתֵּיהֶן פְּטוּרוֹת מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם מִשִּׁמְעוֹן. הָאַחַת מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיְתָה צָרַת עֶרְוָה וְהַשְּׁנִיָּה מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִיא צָרָתָהּ. וְכֵן הַדִּין בְּצָרַת צָרָתָהּ עַד סוֹף הָעוֹלָם. שֶׁכָּל אִשָּׁה שֶׁאֵין לוֹ עָלֶיהָ זִקָּה בְּאִסּוּר אֵשֶׁת אָח עוֹמֶדֶת לְעוֹלָם:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

Accordingly, [the following rules apply when] Reuven dies [childless], leaving two wives, one of whom is forbidden as an ervah to [his brother] Shimon, and both are fit to marry [his brother] Levi. [The wives of] this household are under no obligation at all to Shimon, and both are under obligation to Levi. [The following rule applies if] Levi performed yibbum with the woman who was married [to Reuven] but who was not an ervah to Shimon, [Levi] had another wife, and then he died [childless], and both women fell before to Shimon. They are both free of the obligation to perform either chalitzah or yibbum with Shimon. [Levi's yevamah] is forbidden because she was married to the same man as was a woman forbidden [to Shimon] as an ervah, and the other wife is forbidden because she was married to the same man [as the yevamah]. This principle applies whenever a woman is married to the same man as a woman who was the other wife [of a woman forbidden to the yavam] and to any further extension of this principle. As long as a woman is under no obligation [to her yavam], she remains forbidden to him as his brother's wife.

Halachah 16

וְכֵן אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה בָּעוֹלָמוֹ הוֹאִיל וְאֵין לוֹ עָלֶיהָ זִקָּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כה ה) "כִּי יֵשְׁבוּ אַחִים יַחְדָּו" עַד שֶׁיֵּשְׁבוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם בָּעוֹלָם הֲרֵי זוֹ עֶרְוָה עָלָיו לְעוֹלָם מִשּׁוּם אֵשֶׁת אָח וּפוֹטֶרֶת צָרָתָהּ׃

Similarly, the wife of a brother who died before [his younger brother was born is forbidden to him]. She is under no obligation to him, as implied by [Deuteronomy 25:5]: "When brothers dwell together," interpreted to mean: when they live at the same time. She remains forbidden to him forever, and she frees all of her husband's other wives from an obligation to him.

Halachah 17

כֵּיצַד. רְאוּבֵן שֶׁמֵּת וְהִנִּיחַ אִשָּׁה וְנָפְלָה לִפְנֵי שִׁמְעוֹן וְאַחַר שֶׁמֵּת רְאוּבֵן נוֹלַד לֵוִי. בֵּין שֶׁנּוֹלַד לֵוִי קֹדֶם שֶׁיִּבֵּם לָהּ שִׁמְעוֹן בֵּין שֶׁנּוֹלַד אַחַר שֶׁיִּבְּמָהּ. הֲרֵי אֵשֶׁת רְאוּבֵן עֶרְוָה עַל לֵוִי לְעוֹלָם. לְפִיכָךְ אִם מֵת שִׁמְעוֹן וְנָפְלָה זוֹ וְצָרָתָהּ לִפְנֵי לֵוִי שְׁתֵּיהֶן פְּטוּרוֹת מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם׃

What is implied? Reuven died [childless], leaving a wife who fell before Shimon [his brother]. After Reuven died, whether before Shimon performed yibbum with Reuven's wife or afterwards, Levi [another brother] was born. Reuven's wife remains forbidden to Levi as an ervah forever. Therefore, if Shimon dies [childless], and this woman and another woman [who was married to Shimon] fall before Levi, neither are obligated to perform chalitzah or yibbum.

Halachah 18

עָשָׂה שִׁמְעוֹן מַאֲמָר בִּיבִמְתּוֹ אֵשֶׁת רְאוּבֵן וּמֵת קֹדֶם שֶׁיִּכְנֹס אוֹתָהּ הֲרֵי לֵוִי חוֹלֵץ לְצָרָתָהּ וְלֹא מְיַבֵּם. שֶׁאֵין הַמַּאֲמָר קוֹנֶה בַּיְבָמָה קִנְיָן גָּמוּר כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

[Moreover,] if Shimon [merely] gave a ma'amar to his yevamah, Reuven's wife, and died before he consummated his relationship with her, Levi should perform chalitzah with [Shimon's] other wife, but not yibbum. [The rationale is] that a ma'amar does not establish a completely binding relationship with a yevamah, as we have explained.

Halachah 19

אִשָּׁה שֶׁזִּנְּתָה תַּחַת בַּעְלָהּ בְּרָצוֹן וּבְעֵדִים וּמֵת קֹדֶם שֶׁיִּגְרְשֶׁנָּה וְנָפְלָה לִפְנֵי יָבָם הֲרֵי הִיא פְּטוּרָה מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם. וְכֵן צָרָתָהּ כְּאִלּוּ הָיְתָה עֶרְוָה עַל הַיָּבָם מִפְּנֵי שֶׁטֻּמְאָה כְּתוּבָה בָּהּ כַּעֲרָיוֹת שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה יג יד) "וְהִיא נִטְמָאָה". אֲבָל סוֹטָה שֶׁמֵּת בַּעְלָהּ קֹדֶם שֶׁיַּשְׁקֶנָּה מֵי הַמָּרִים אוֹ שֶׁאֵינָהּ בַּת שְׁתִיָּה אֶלָּא בַּת גֵּרוּשִׁין הֲרֵי זוֹ חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וְאִם הָיְתָה לָהּ צָרָה הֲרֵי צָרָתָהּ מֻתֶּרֶת וְחוֹלֶצֶת אוֹ מִתְיַבֶּמֶת:

When a woman willingly commits adultery while married to her husband, and [her act is observed by] witnesses [he is required to divorce her]. If he died [childless] before he divorced her, and she fell before a yavam, she is not obligated to perform chalitzah or yibbum. Moreover, [her deceased husband's] other wives are also [not obligated to perform chalitzah or yibbum], as if she were forbidden to the yavam as an ervah. For just as impurity is mentioned with regard to the arayot, so too, that term is mentioned with regard to such a woman, as [Numbers 5:13] states: "And she became impure." When, however, the husband of a sotah dies [childless] before he has caused her to her drink the bitter waters, or if the woman must be divorced instead of drinking the bitter waters, she should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum. Similarly, if [her deceased husband] had another wife, that woman is permitted [to the yavam] and may perform chalitzah or yibbum.

Halachah 20

וְכֵן שְׁתֵּי יְבָמוֹת הַבָּאוֹת מִבַּיִת אֶחָד שֶׁהָיְתָה הָאַחַת מֵהֶן שְׁנִיָּה עַל הַיָּבָם אוֹ מֵחַיְבֵי לָאוִין אוֹ מֵחַיְבֵי עֲשֵׂה אוֹ אַיְלוֹנִית הֲרֵי צָרָתָהּ מֻתֶּרֶת וְחוֹלֶצֶת אוֹ מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. אֲבָל הַחוֹלֵץ לִיבְמְתּוֹ וְהָלְכָה אֶחוֹת חֲלוּצָתוֹ אוֹ אִמָּהּ וְכִיּוֹצֵא בָּהֶן וְנִשֵּׂאת לְאָחִיו וְלוֹ אִשָּׁה אַחֶרֶת וָמֵת וְנָפְלוּ שְׁתֵּיהֶן לְפָנָיו. כְּשֵׁם שֶׁקְּרוֹבַת חֲלוּצָתוֹ אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו כָּךְ צָרָתָהּ אֲסוּרָה. וַהֲרֵי שְׁתֵּיהֶן כִּשְׁנֵיּוֹת לוֹ וְחוֹלְצוֹת וְלֹא מִתְיַבְּמוֹת. וּמִפְּנֵי מָה אָסְרוּ צָרַת קְרוֹבַת חֲלוּצָתוֹ. מִפְּנֵי שֶׁמִּתְחַלֶּפֶת בְּצָרַת חֲלוּצָתוֹ:

Similar rules [apply] if two yevamot come from one household and one of them was a sh'niyah to the yavam, [forbidden to him because of] a negative commandment or a positive commandment, or an aylonit - another wife of [her deceased husband] is permitted [to the yavam] and may perform chalitzah or yibbum. [Different rules apply, however, when a yavam] performed chalitzah with his yevamah, and then the sister, the mother, or another [close relative] of the woman with whom he performed chalitzah married another one of his brothers, that brother has another wife, and [the brother] dies [childless]. Just as the close relative of the woman with whom he performed chalitzah is forbidden to him, so

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too, is the other wife forbidden to him. Their status is like sh'niyot, and they should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum. Why did the Sages forbid [marriage] to a close relative of a woman with whom one performed chalitzah? Because it is difficult to distinguish her from a woman married to the same man as a woman with whom one performed chalitzah.

Halachah 21

שְׁתֵּי יְבָמוֹת הַבָּאוֹת מִבַּיִת אֶחָד שֶׁהָאַחַת מֵהֶן עֶרְוָה עַל הַיָּבָם וַהֲרֵי הָעֶרְוָה אַיְלוֹנִית. צָרָתָהּ מֻתֶּרֶת וְחוֹלָצֶת אוֹ מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. הוֹאִיל וְהָאַיְלוֹנִית אֵינָהּ בַּת יִבּוּם וַחֲלִיצָה הֲרֵי זוֹ כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינָהּ. וְנָפְלָה זִקָּתוֹ עַל צָרָתָהּ בִּלְבַד. וְכֵן אִם גֵּרֵשׁ אָחִיו אֶת הָעֶרְוָה אוֹ מֵאֲנָה בּוֹ קֹדֶם שֶׁיָּמוּת. אוֹ שֶׁמֵּתָה בְּחַיֵּי בַּעְלָהּ וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵת אָחִיו. הֲרֵי צָרָתָהּ מֻתֶּרֶת וְחוֹלָצֶת אוֹ מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וְאֵין אוֹמְרִין הוֹאִיל וְנַעֲשֵׂית צָרָה לְעֶרְוָה שָׁעָה אַחַת תֵּאָסֵר לְעוֹלָם. שֶׁאֵין הַצָּרָה אֲסוּרָה עַד שֶׁתִּהְיֶה צָרַת עֶרְוָה בִּשְׁעַת נְפִילָה לְיִבּוּם:

When two yevamot come from one household and one of them was forbidden to the yavam as an ervah, but she was also an aylonit, the other wife of [the deceased husband] is permitted [to the yavam] and may perform chalitzah or yibbum. [The rationale is that] since the laws of yibbum and chalitzah do not apply with regard to an aylonit, it is as if she did not exist, and the obligation [of yibbum] falls on the other wife alone. Similarly, if [the deceased] brother divorced the woman forbidden as an ervah or she dissolved their marriage through] mi'un before he died, or she died during the lifetime of the deceased brother, and then he died, his other wife is permitted and should perform either chalitzah or yibbum. We do not say that since she was married to the same man as an ervah once, she remains forbidden forever. For a woman married to the same man as an ervah does not become forbidden [to the yavam] unless they were [both married to the same man at the time of his death, when] the obligation of yibbum takes effect.

Halachah 22

הָיְתָה זוֹ שֶׁהִיא עֶרְוָה עַל הַיָּבָם מְקֻדֶּשֶׁת לְאָחִיו שֶׁמֵּת בְּסָפֵק אוֹ מְגֹרֶשֶׁת מִמֶּנּוּ בְּסָפֵק. אוֹ שֶׁהָיְתָה קְטַנָּה הָרְאוּיָה לְמָאֵן וְלֹא מֵאֲנָה בְּאָחִיו בְּחַיָּיו. אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁמֵּאֲנָה בַּיָּבָם צָרָתָהּ חוֹלָצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת:

[In the situation mentioned in Halachah 14,] if there was a doubt regarding the status of the kiddushin of [the woman] who was forbidden to the yavam as an ervah or there was a doubt that she was divorced, the other wife [of the deceased brother] should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum. [The same ruling applies if the woman who was forbidden] was a minor who is fit to absolve her marriage through mi'un, if she did not dissolve her marriage [to the deceased] brother during his lifetime, even though she did dissolve her obligation to] the yavam through mi'un, another woman married to her husband must perform chalitzah; she may not perform yibbum.

Halachah 23

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

הָלְכָה צָרַת עֶרְוָה וְנִשֵּׂאת לְאַחֵר וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִמְצֵאת הָעֶרְוָה אַיְלוֹנִית. תֵּצֵא הַצָּרָה מִבַּעְלָהּ וּמִיבָמָהּ וּצְרִיכָה גֵּט מִבַּעְלָהּ וַחֲלִיצָה מִיבָמָהּ כְּדֵי לְהַתִּירָהּ לַשּׁוּק:

[In the situation mentioned in Halachah 14,] if the other woman [married to the deceased brother] married another man, and then it was discovered that [the woman forbidden to the yavam as] an ervah was an aylonit, the woman who married must be released by both her [second] husband and her yavam. Her [second] husband must divorce her with a get, while her yavam must perform chalitzah with her. [In this way,] she is permitted to marry another man.

Halachah 24

יִבֵּם הַיָּבָם הַצָּרָה מִפְּנֵי שֶׁדִּמּוּ שֶׁהָעֶרְוָה אַיְלוֹנִית וְנִמְצֵאת הָעֶרְוָה שֶׁאֵינָהּ אַיְלוֹנִית תֵּצֵא מִיבָמָהּ בְּגֵט וְהַוָּלָד מַמְזֵר:

[In the above situation], if the yavam performed yibbum with the other wife of the deceased, because he thought that the woman forbidden to him as an ervah was an aylonit, and it was discovered that she was not an aylonit, the yavam must divorce [the woman with whom he performed yibbum] with a get. Any child [she bears him] is illegitimate.

Halachah 25

שְׁלֹשָׁה אַחִין. שְׁנַיִם מֵהֶן נְשׂוּאִין שְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת וְאֶחָד מֵהֶן נָשׂוּי נָכְרִית. מֵת הַנָּשׂוּי נָכְרִית וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵת אֶחָד מִבַּעֲלֵי אֲחָיוֹת. הֲרֵי הַנָּכְרִית חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִיא צָרַת אֲחוֹת אִשְׁתּוֹ בְּזִקַּת אָחִיו שֶׁמֵּת אַחֲרוֹן. וְלֹא עוֹד אֶלָּא אֲפִלּוּ גֵּרֵשׁ אֶחָד מִבַּעֲלֵי אֲחָיוֹת אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ אַחַר שֶׁמֵּת הַנָּשׂוּי נָכְרִית וּמֵת הַמְגֹרָשׁ הֲרֵי הַנָּכְרִית חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת הוֹאִיל וְנַעֲשֵׂית צָרַת אָחוֹת אִשְׁתּוֹ בְּזִקָּה שָׁעָה אַחַת. שֶׁאִם תִּתְיַבֵּם שֶׁמָּא יָבֹא לְיַבֵּם אוֹתָהּ. וַאֲפִלּוּ לֹא גֵּרֵשׁ זֶה שֶׁמֵּת אַחֲרוֹן אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ:

[In the following situation, chalitzah and not yibbum is required.] There were three brothers. Two were married to two sisters, and one was married to a woman who did not share a family connection. If the brother married to the woman who was not related died [childless], and then one of the brothers married to one of the sisters died [childless], [the remaining brother] should perform chalitzah but not yibbum, with the woman who did not share a family connection. [The rationale is that] she was obligated to the second brother, and his other wife was the sister [of the surviving yavam's] wife. Moreover, even if one of the brothers who married one of the sisters divorced his wife after the brother married to the woman who was not related died [childless], and then he himself dies [childless], [the remaining brother] should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum, with the woman who did not share a family connection. Since there was even one moment when this woman was obligated to the second brother while his other wife was the sister [of the surviving yavam's] wife [this prohibition was enforced]. For if [he] were [allowed to] perform yibbum with her, it is possible that [in such a situation, a brother] might perform yibbum with such

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

a woman even when the second brother who died did not divorce his wife.

Halachah 26

וּמִפְּנֵי מָה לֹא גָּזְרוּ דָּבָר זֶה בַּנְּשׂוּאִין שֶׁהֲרֵי צָרַת עֶרְוָה בַּנְּשׂוּאִין אִם גֵּרֵשׁ אֶת הָעֶרְוָה וּמֵת צָרָתָהּ מֻתֶּרֶת לַיָּבָם כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ. מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאִסּוּר צָרַת הָעֶרְוָה בַּנְּשׂוּאִין יָדוּעַ לַכֹּל וְאֵינָן בָּאִין לְהַתִּיר הַצָּרָה אִם לֹא גֵּרֵשׁ הָעֶרְוָה. וְאִסּוּר צָרַת עֶרְוָה בְּזִיקָה אֵינוֹ יָדוּעַ לַכֹּל וּבָאִין לְהַתִּיר הַצָּרָה וַאֲפִלּוּ לֹא נִתְגָּרְשָׁה הָעֶרְוָה:

Why was this decree not applied when a marriage was involved? For example, if [a brother is married to two women,] one of them is forbidden [to his brother] as an ervah and one is not. If he divorces the wife who is forbidden and then dies childless, [the surviving brother] may perform yibbum with the wife [of the deceased brother], as we have explained. [The distinction is that] the prohibition against [performing yibbum] with a wife [of one's deceased brother] when one of his wives is forbidden [to the yavam] as ervah is known by all. Thus, if [the deceased brother] did not divorce the woman forbidden [to the yavam], no one would allow him [to perform yibbum with his brother's] other wife. The prohibition against [performing yibbum with] a woman who was obligated to [a man whose] other wife is forbidden [to the yavam] is not known to all, and it is possible that [in such a situation, a brother] might be allowed to [perform yibbum with] such a woman even when [the second brother who died] did not divorce the forbidden woman.

Halachah 27

שְׁלֹשָׁה אַחִין נְשׂוּאִין שְׁלֹשׁ נָשִׁים נָכְרִיּוֹת. מֵת אֶחָד מֵהֶן וְעָשָׂה הַשֵּׁנִי מַאֲמָר בִּיבִמְתּוֹ וּמֵת קֹדֶם שֶׁיִּכְנֹס וְנָפְלוּ שְׁתֵּיהֶן לִפְנֵי הַיָּבָם הֲרֵי אֵלּוּ חוֹלְצוֹת וְלֹא מִתְיַבְּמוֹת. מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבַּעֲלַת הַמַּאֲמָר עָלֶיהָ זִקַּת שְׁנֵי יְבָמִין. וְנִמְצֵאת כְּאִלּוּ הִיא אֵשֶׁת שְׁנֵי מֵתִים. וְדָרְשׁוּ חֲכָמִים וְאָמְרוּ (דברים כה ה) "אֵשֶׁת הַמֵּת" וְלֹא אֵשֶׁת שְׁנֵי מֵתִים. לְפִיכָךְ כָּל אִשָּׁה שֶׁעָלֶיהָ זִקַּת שְׁנֵי יְבָמִין חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת וְכֵן צָרָתָהּ. וְאִסּוּרָן מִדִּבְרֵי סוֹפְרִים:

[In the following situation, chalitzah and not yibbum is required.] There were three brothers, all married to women who did not share any family connection. One of the brothers died [childless]. Another gave his yevamah a ma'amar, but died [childless] before he consummated his marriage to her. Thus, this woman and the wife of the second brother fell before the third brother. These women should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum, because the woman who was given the ma'amar has two obligations for yibbum incumbent on her. As such, it is as if she had been married to two men. Our Sages interpreted the phrase [Deuteronomy 25:5] "the wife of the deceased," as a restriction. [One may perform yibbum with the wife of one deceased man,] but not [the wife of] two deceased men. Therefore, whenever a woman has two obligations for yibbum incumbent on her, she should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum. The same applies to the woman married to [the

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second brother who died]. The prohibition [against performing yibbum with these women] is Rabbinic in origin.

Halachah 28

וּמִפְּנֵי מָה לֹא יַחֲלֹץ לְבַעֲלַת הַמַּאֲמָר שֶׁעָלֶיהָ זִקַּת שְׁנֵי יְבָמִין וְייַבֵּם צָרָתָהּ. גְּזֵרָה שֶׁלֹּא יֹאמְרוּ שְׁתֵּי יְבָמוֹת הַבָּאוֹת מִבַּיִת אֶחָד אַחַת חוֹלֶצֶת וְאַחַת מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. וּלְפִיכָךְ אָסְרוּ אַף צָרָתָהּ:

Why does [the yavam] not merely perform chalitzah with the woman who was given the ma'amar and is thus obligated to perform yibbum because of two men, and then perform yibbum with the [first] wife of [the deceased brother]? This is a decree instituted so that people will not say that when there are two yevamot coming from one household, one should perform chalitzah and the other yibbum. For this reason, [the Sages] forbade [performing yibbum with the deceased's first] wife.

Halachah 29

עָשָׂה מַאֲמָר בִּיבִמְתּוֹ וְנָתַן גֵּט לְמַאֲמָרוֹ וּמֵת חָזְרָה לְהֶתֵּרָהּ. שֶׁהַמַּאֲמָר שֶׁאֲסָרָהּ הֵרֵי בִּטְּלוֹ. וְרָצָה חוֹלֵץ רָצָה מְיַבֵּם:

[In the above instance, if the second brother] gave his yevamah a ma'amar and then gave her a get [to nullify] the ma'amar, [different rules apply] if he dies. [The woman] becomes permitted [to the third brother], for the ma'amar that caused her to be forbidden was nullified. He may perform either chalitzah or yibbum with her.

Halachah 30

בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁבָּא עַל יְבִמְתּוֹ וּמֵת כְּשֶׁהוּא קָטָן וְנָפְלָה פַּעַם שְׁנִיָּה לִפְנֵי אָחִיו הַגָּדוֹל הֲרֵי זוֹ חוֹלֶצֶת וְלֹא מִתְיַבֶּמֶת. שֶׁבִּיאַת בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד כְּמַאֲמָר מִן הַגָּדוֹל כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ וְנִמְצָא עָלֶיהָ זִקַּת שְׁנֵי יְבָמִין:

[In the following situation, chalitzah and not yibbum is required. A yavam] who is below the age of majority, [but more than] nine years and one day old, enters into relations with his yevamah and dies before he attains majority. She then becomes obligated for yibbum to the minor's older brother for a second time. She should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum. As we have explained, relations in which a minor engages are considered equivalent to a ma'amar given by [a brother] past majority. Hence, the woman has two obligations for yibbum incumbent on her.

Halachah 31

מִי שֶׁחָצְיָהּ שִׁפְחָה וְחָצְיָהּ בַּת חוֹרִין שֶׁנִּתְקַדְּשָׁה לִרְאוּבֵן וְנִשְׁתַּחְרְרָה וְחָזְרָה וְנִתְקַדְּשָׁה לְשִׁמְעוֹן וּמֵתוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם מִתְיַבֶּמֶת לְלֵוִי וְאֵינָהּ אֵשֶׁת שְׁנֵי מֵתִים. אִם קִדּוּשֵׁי רְאוּבֵן קִדּוּשֵׁי אֵין קִדּוּשֵׁי שִׁמְעוֹן כְּלוּם.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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וְאִם קִדּוּשֵׁי שִׁמְעוֹן קִדּוּשִׁין אֵין קִדּוּשֵׁי רְאוּבֵן כְּלוּם:

[The following rule applies when] a woman who was half [a Canaanite] maid-servant and half a freed woman was consecrated by Reuven. She was then given her freedom and was consecrated by [Reuven's brother,] Shimon. Afterwards, both [brothers] died. Levi, [a third brother, may] perform yibbum with [this woman]; she is not considered to be "the wife of two deceased men." For if her consecration by Reuven is effective, her consecration by Shimon is of no consequence. And if her consecration by Shimon is effective, her consecration by Reuven is of no consequence.

Commentary

Chapter 6 is a taxonomy — the Rambam sorts every possible configuration of brothers and yevamot into fit and unfit for yibbum or chalitzah. Thirty-one halachot march through the cases: brothers fit for either rite, brothers fit for neither, yevamot whose status blocks the mitzvah, the intricate fallout when one brother's marriage exempts another's widow. The architecture is pure Rambam: state the principle, then exhaust the permutations, each halachah a cell in a complete grid.

The Maggid Mishneh does what he always does — he names the address. Nearly every halachah here is traced to its Talmudic source: 'mishnah, perek Ketzad (daf 20)', 'the conclusion of the gemara, perek Kama (daf 12)', the full mishnah of 'three brothers, two married to two sisters' from Yevamot 30. The Rambam's grid turns out to be a mosaic of sugyot, each tile cut from the Talmud and set without mortar — the sources are visible in the seams for anyone who knows where to look.

Migdal Oz adds the literary observation: the chapter's opening halachot are introductions 'in the manner of authors, on what is to come.' The Rambam first announces the categories — fit for yibbum, fit for chalitzah, fit for neither — and only then fills them. It is the same move as a map before a journey: the taxonomy precedes the cases because the mind needs the shelves before the books.

The gem of the chapter is halachah 25's case, which the Maggid Mishneh unpacks at length: three brothers, two married to sisters, one to an outsider; divorces and deaths cascade until the question is whose co-wives are permitted. The Talmud's answer turns on a razor's edge — whether the divorce preceded the death — and the Rambam carries it over intact. Conceptual elegance inside casuistic density: that is the chapter's signature.

Commentary: Maggid Mishneh (source-tracer) and Migdal Oz, via Sefaria.

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 7

Genesis 5:25-6:8

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DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

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The seventh aliyah closes Bereshit: the genealogy runs from Methuselah through Lamech to Noah — 'this one will comfort us' — and then the narrative breaks open. The sons of Elohim take wives, Nephilim walk the earth, and God sees that every plan of the human heart is only evil all day long. We read each verse twice in Hebrew and once in Onkelos, as the shnayim mikra practice requires.

שנה ויולד שנין

Genesis 5:25 · ×2

וַיְחִי מְתוּשֶׁלַח שֶׁבַע וּשְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־לָמֶךְ׃
וַיְחִי מְתוּשֶׁלַח שֶׁבַע וּשְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־לָמֶךְ׃
וַחֲיָא מְתוּשֶׁלַח מְאָה וְתַמְנִין וּשְׁבַע שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת לֶמֶךְ׃

Genesis 5:26 · ×2

וַיְחִי מְתוּשֶׁלַח אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־לֶמֶךְ שְׁתַּיִם וּשְׁמוֹנִים שָׁנָה וּשְׁבַע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַיְחִי מְתוּשֶׁלַח אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־לֶמֶךְ שְׁתַּיִם וּשְׁמוֹנִים שָׁנָה וּשְׁבַע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא מְתוּשֶׁלַח בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת לֶמֶךְ שִׁבְעִין וְתַמְנִין וְתַרְתֵּין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 5:27 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי מְתוּשֶׁלַח תֵּשַׁע וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי מְתוּשֶׁלַח תֵּשַׁע וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַהֲווֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי מְתוּשֶׁלַח תְּשַׁע מְאָה וְשִׁתִּין וּתְשַׁע שְׁנִין וּמִית׃

Genesis 5:28 · ×2

וַיְחִי־לֶמֶךְ שְׁתַּיִם וּשְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בֵּן׃
וַיְחִי־לֶמֶךְ שְׁתַּיִם וּשְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בֵּן׃
וַחֲיָא לֶמֶךְ מְאָה וְתַמְנִין וְתַרְתֵּין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בַּר׃

יהוה

Genesis 5:29 · ×2

וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ נֹחַ לֵאמֹר זֶה יְנַחֲמֵנוּ מִמַּעֲשֵׂנוּ וּמֵעִצְּבוֹן יָדֵינוּ מִן־הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר אֵרְרָהּ יְהוָה׃
וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ נֹחַ לֵאמֹר זֶה יְנַחֲמֵנוּ מִמַּעֲשֵׂנוּ וּמֵעִצְּבוֹן יָדֵינוּ מִן־הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר אֵרְרָהּ יְהוָה׃
וּקְרָא יָת שְׁמֵהּ נֹחַ לְמֵימַר דֵּין יְנַחֲמִנָּא מֵעוֹבָדָנָא וּמִלְּאוּת יְדָנָא מִן אַרְעָא דִּי לַטָּטַהּ יְיָ׃

Genesis 5:30 · ×2

וַיְחִי־לֶמֶךְ אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־נֹחַ חָמֵשׁ וְתִשְׁעִים שָׁנָה וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַיְחִי־לֶמֶךְ אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־נֹחַ חָמֵשׁ וְתִשְׁעִים שָׁנָה וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא לֶמֶךְ בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת נֹחַ חֲמֵשׁ מְאָה וְתִשְׁעִין וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

Genesis 5:31 · ×2

וַיְהִי֙ כָּל־יְמֵי־לֶ֔מֶךְ שֶׁ֥בַע וְשִׁבְעִ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּשְׁבַ֥ע מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֑ה וַיָּמֹֽת׃
וַיְהִי֙ כָּל־יְמֵי־לֶ֔מֶךְ שֶׁ֥בַע וְשִׁבְעִ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּשְׁבַ֥ע מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֑ה וַיָּמֹֽת׃
וַהֲווֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי לֶ֒מֶךְ שִׁבְעִין וּשְׁבַע שְׁנִין וּמְית׃

Genesis 5:32 · ×2

וַיְהִי־נֹ֖חַ בֶּן־חֲמֵ֣שׁ מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד נֹ֛חַ אֶת־שֵׁ֖ם אֶת־חָ֥ם וְאֶת־יָֽפֶת׃
וַיְהִי־נֹ֖חַ בֶּן־חֲמֵ֣שׁ מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד נֹ֛חַ אֶת־שֵׁ֖ם אֶת־חָ֥ם וְאֶת־יָֽפֶת׃
וַהֲוָה נֹחַ בַּר חֲמֵשׁ מְאָה שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד נֹחַ יָת שֵׁם יָת חָם וְיָת יָפֶת׃

אנשא

Genesis 6:1 · ×2

וַיְהִי֙ כִּֽי־הֵחֵ֣ל הָאָדָ֔ם לָרֹ֖ב עַל־פְּנֵ֣י הָאֲדָמָ֑ה וּבָנ֥וֹת יֻלְּד֖וּ לָהֶֽם׃
וַיְהִי֙ כִּֽי־הֵחֵ֣ל הָאָדָ֔ם לָרֹ֖ב עַל־פְּנֵ֣י הָאֲדָמָ֑ה וּבָנ֥וֹת יֻלְּד֖וּ לָהֶֽם׃
וַהֲוָה כַּד שְׁרִיאוּ בְנֵי אֱנָשָׁא לְמִסְגֵּי עַל אַפֵּי אַרְעָא וּבְנָתָא אִתְיְלִידוּ לְהוֹן׃

Genesis 6:2 · ×2

וַיִּרְא֣וּ בְנֵי־הָאֱלֹקִ֗ים אֶת־בְּנ֤וֹת הָאָדָם֙ כִּ֣י טֹבֹ֔ת הֵ֑נָּה וַיִּקְח֥וּ לָהֶ֛ם נָשִׁ֖ים מִכֹּ֥ל אֲשֶׁר־בָּחָֽרוּ׃
וַיִּרְא֣וּ בְנֵי־הָאֱלֹקִ֗ים אֶת־בְּנ֤וֹת הָאָדָם֙ כִּ֣י טֹבֹ֔ת הֵ֑נָּה וַיִּקְח֥וּ לָהֶ֛ם נָשִׁ֖ים מִכֹּ֥ל אֲשֶׁר־בָּחָֽרוּ׃
וַחֲזוֹ בְנֵי רַבְרְבַיָּא יָת בְּנַת אֱנָשָׁא אֲרֵי שַׁפִּירָן אִנּוּן וּנְסִיבוּ לְהוֹן נְשִׁין מִכֹּל דִּי אִתְרְעִיאוּ׃

Genesis 6:3 · ×2

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר יְהוָ֔ה לֹא־יָד֥וֹן רוּחִ֖י בָּאָדָ֣ם לְעֹלָ֑ם בְּשַׁגַּ֥ם הוּא֙ בָּשָׂ֔ר וְהָי֥וּ יָמָ֖יו מֵאָ֣ה וְעֶשְׂרִ֔ים שָׁנָֽה׃
וַיֹּ֣אמֶר יְהוָ֔ה לֹא־יָד֥וֹן רוּחִ֖י בָּאָדָ֣ם לְעֹלָ֑ם בְּשַׁגַּ֥ם הוּא֙ בָּשָׂ֔ר וְהָי֥וּ יָמָ֖יו מֵאָ֣ה וְעֶשְׂרִ֔ים שָׁנָֽה׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ לָא יִתְקַיֵּם דָּרָא בִישָׁא הָדֵין קֳדָמַי לְעָלַם בְּדִיל דְּאִנּוּן בִּשְׂרָא וְעוֹבָדֵיהוֹן בִּישַׁיָּא אַרְכָא יְהִיבַת לְהוֹן מְאָה וְעַשְׂרִין שְׁנִין אִם יְתוּבוּן׃

Genesis 6:4 · ×2

הַנְּפִלִ֞ים הָי֣וּ בָאָ֗רֶץ בַּיָּמִים֮ הָהֵם֒ וְגַ֣ם אַחֲרֵי־כֵ֗ן אֲשֶׁ֤ר יָבֹ֙אוּ֙ בְּנֵ֣י הָאֱלֹקִ֔ים אֶל־בְּנ֥וֹת הָאָדָ֖ם וְיָלְד֣וּ לָהֶ֑ם הֵ֣מָּה הַגִּבֹּרִ֗ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר מֵעוֹלָ֛ם אַנְשֵׁ֥י הַשֵּֽׁם׃
הַנְּפִלִ֞ים הָי֣וּ בָאָ֗רֶץ בַּיָּמִים֮ הָהֵם֒ וְגַ֣ם אַחֲרֵי־כֵ֗ן אֲשֶׁ֤ר יָבֹ֙אוּ֙ בְּנֵ֣י הָאֱלֹקִ֔ים אֶל־בְּנ֥וֹת הָאָדָ֖ם וְיָלְד֣וּ לָהֶ֑ם הֵ֣מָּה הַגִּבֹּרִ֗ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר מֵעוֹלָ֛ם אַנְשֵׁ֥י הַשֵּֽׁם׃
גִּבָּרַיָּא הֲווֹ בְאַרְעָא בְּיוֹמַיָּא הָאִנּוּן וְאַף בָּתַר כֵּן דִּי יַעֲלוּן בְּנֵי רַבְרְבַיָּא לְוָת בְּנַת אֱנָשָׁא וְיַלִּידָן לְהוֹן אִנּוּן גִּבָּרַיָּא דְּמֵעָלְמָא אֱנָשִׁין דִּשְׁמָא׃

Genesis 6:5 · ×2

וַיַּ֣רְא יְהוָ֔ה כִּ֥י רַבָּ֖ה רָעַ֣ת הָאָדָ֑ם בָּאָ֔רֶץ וְכָל־יֵ֣צֶר֙ מַחְשְׁבֹ֣ת לִבּ֔וֹ רַ֥ק רַ֖ע כָּל־הַיּֽוֹם׃
וַיַּ֣רְא יְהוָ֔ה כִּ֥י רַבָּ֖ה רָעַ֣ת הָאָדָ֑ם בָּאָ֔רֶץ וְכָל־יֵ֣צֶר֙ מַחְשְׁבֹ֣ת לִבּ֔וֹ רַ֥ק רַ֖ע כָּל־הַיּֽוֹם׃
וַחֲזָא יְיָ אֲרֵי סְגִיאַת בִּישַׁת אֱנָשָׁא בְּאַרְעָא וְכָל יְצִרָא מַחְשְׁבַת לִבֵּהּ לְחוֹד בִּישׁ כָּל יוֹמָא׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

Genesis 6:6 · ×2

וַיִּנָּחֶם יְהוָה כִּי־עָשָׂה אֶת־הָאָדָם בָּאָרֶץ וַיִּתְעַצֵּב אֶל־לִבּוֹ׃
וַיִּנָּחֶם יְהוָה כִּי־עָשָׂה אֶת־הָאָדָם בָּאָרֶץ וַיִּתְעַצֵּב אֶל־לִבּוֹ׃
וְתַב יְיָ בְּמֵימְרֵהּ אֲרֵי עֲבַד יָת אֱנָשָׁא בְּאַרְעָא וַאֲמַר בְּמֵימְרֵהּ לְמִתְבַר תְּקִפְּהוֹן כִּרְעוּתֵהּ׃

Genesis 6:7 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶמְחֶה אֶת־הָאָדָם אֲשֶׁר־בָּרָאתִי מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה מֵאָדָם עַד־בְּהֵמָה עַד־רֶמֶשׂ וְעַד־עוֹף הַשָּׁמָיִם כִּי נִחַמְתִּי כִּי עֲשִׂיתִם׃
וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶמְחֶה אֶת־הָאָדָם אֲשֶׁר־בָּרָאתִי מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה מֵאָדָם עַד־בְּהֵמָה עַד־רֶמֶשׂ וְעַד־עוֹף הַשָּׁמָיִם כִּי נִחַמְתִּי כִּי עֲשִׂיתִם׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ אֶמְחֵי יָת אֱנָשָׁא דִּי בְרֵאתִי מֵעַל אַפֵּי אַרְעָא מֵאֱנָשָׁא עַד בְּעִירָא עַד רִיחֲשָׁא וְעַד עוֹפָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא אֲרֵי תָּבִית בְּמֵימְרִי אֲרֵי עֲבַדְתִּנּוּן׃

Genesis 6:8 · ×2

וְנֹחַ מָצָא חֵן בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה׃
וְנֹחַ מָצָא חֵן בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה׃
וְנֹחַ אַשְׁכַּח רַחֲמִין קֳדָם יְיָ׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 6:2

Notes the ancient view (angels, as in Job) but argues the angels' bodies were never their own — only appearances — undercutting the literal angelic reading from within.

Shadal · Gen 6:4

The Nephilim were tall men (cf. Numbers 13:33), and 'and also afterwards' proves they survived the Flood — so the verse's syntax must reach backward, not forward.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 6:2

Bnei ha-Elohim are the judges who administered God's justice on earth — or, alternatively, the Sethites who 'knew the knowledge of the Most High,' each drawn by astral affinity to his mate.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 6:3

Parses ידון three ways — from נדן (sheath, the body as the spirit's sheath), from a root like נשא, or from דין (the spirit as judge over the body) — a grammarian's triple play on one verb.

Cassuto · Gen 6:2

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

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Rejects every reading — ancient and modern — that makes bnei ha-Elohim a class of human beings; the phrase stands in deliberate antithesis to 'daughters of man,' and the contrast is the point.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 6:2

בני רברביא בני האלקים

Onkelos demythologizes: 'sons of God' becomes 'sons of the great ones' — the judges and rulers reading, refusing the angelic interpretation outright.

Gen 6:3

לא יתקיים דרא בישא הדין קדמי לעלם לא ידון רוחי באדם לעלם

A full paraphrase: 'this evil generation shall not endure before Me forever.' Onkelos sidesteps the crux of ידון entirely and moralizes the decree — the קדמי ('before Me') periphrasis keeps the divine at a remove.

Gen 6:4

גבריא הנפלים

'The Nephilim' become simply 'the mighty ones' — no fallen ones, no giants of myth; Onkelos rationalizes the most mythic word in the aliyah into ordinary strongmen.

Gen 6:6

ותב יי במימרה וינחם יהוה

Divine regret is unthinkable: 'and the Lord relented' becomes 'and the Lord relented in His word' — the מימרה (word) buffer absorbs the anthropopathy.

Gen 6:6

ואמר במימרה למתבר תקפהון כרעותה ויתעצב אל לבו

'He was grieved to His heart' is rewritten as a judicial decree: 'He said in His word to break their strength according to His will.' Grief becomes verdict.

Gen 6:8

אשכח רחמין קדם יי מצא חן בעיני יהוה

'Found favor in the eyes of the Lord' 'found mercy before the Lord.' The קדם periphrasis again — Noah stands before God, never face to face.

Gen 5:29

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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דין ינחמננא זה ינחמנו

Straightforward here — but note what Onkelos does not do: he keeps the wordplay (נח/נחם) intact, letting the naming-speech carry its own comfort.

RASHI

Rashi on Genesis 5:25-6:8

All 23 of Rashi's comments on the seventh aliyah, from Lamech's naming of Noah to Noah finding favor — including the great cruxes: who are the sons of Elohim, what are the 120 years, and why does God 'regret.'

ויולד בן.

שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ נִבְנָה הָעוֹלָם (בראשית רבה):

ויולד בן *AND HE BEGOT A SON* (בן *"son", connected with the root* בנה *"to build") — from whom the world was built up (peopled) (Tanchuma 1:1:11)*

זה ינחמנו.

יָנַח מִמֶּנּוּ אֶת עִצְּבוֹן יָדֵינוּ. עַד שֶׁלֹּא בָא נֹחַ לֹא הָיָה לָהֶם כְּלֵי מַחֲרֵשָׁה וְהוּא הֵכִין לָהֶם וְהָיְתָה הָאָרֶץ מוֹצִיאָה קוֹצִים וְדַרְדַּרִים כְּשֶׁזּוֹרְעִים חִטִּים, מִקִּלְלָתוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, וּבִימֵי נֹחַ נָחָה, וְזֶהוּ יְנַחֲמֵנוּ,

זה ינחמנו *THIS WILL COMFORT US — He will ease from off us* (ינחמנו) *the toil of our hands.*

For until Noah came people had no agricultural instruments and he prepared such for them.

The earth had brought forth thorns and thistles when they sowed wheat in consequence of the curse imposed upon Adam Harishon:

וְאִם לֹא תִפְרְשֵׁהוּ כָּךְ אֵין טַעַם הַלָּשׁוֹן נוֹפֵל עַל הַשֵּׁם וְאַתָּה צָרִיךְ לִקְרוֹת שְׁמוֹ מְנַחֵם:

in the days of Noah, however, this ceased (Tanchuma 1:1:11).

This is what is meant by the word ינחמנו *(viz.,* ינח מנו*).*

If, however, you do not explain it in this manner, but from the root נחם *"to comfort", then the meaning you give to this expression (connecting it with the idea of "comfort") will have no application to the name* נח*, and you would have to call him* מנחם *"Comforter".*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

בן חמש מאות שנה.

אָמַר רַבִּי יוּדָן מַה טַּעַם כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת הוֹלִידוּ לְק' שָׁנָה וְזֶה לַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת?

אָמַר הַקָּבָ"ה אִם רְשָׁעִים הֵם יֹאבְדוּ בַּמַּיִם וְרַע לְצַדִּיק זֶה,

בן חמש מאות שנה *FIVE HUNDRED YEARS OLD — R. Judan said: "How is it that all the previous generations had children at the age of hundred years and this one (Noah) at the age of 500 years?*

וְאִם צַדִּיקִים הֵם אַטְרִיחַ עָלָיו לַעֲשׂוֹת תֵּבוֹת הַרְבֵּה,

The Holy One, blessed be He, said, "If they (Noah's children) be wicked, they will perish by the water of the Flood and it will grieve this righteous man;

כְּבַשׁ אֶת מַעְיָנוֹ וְלֹא הוֹלִיד עַד חֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה,

if they be righteous, I shall have to trouble him to construct several arks." He therefore restrained him from having children until he was 500 years old, in order that Japhet, the oldest of his sons (cf.

כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא יְהֵא יֶפֶת הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבִּבָנָיו רָאוּי לְעָנְשִׁין לִפְנֵי הַמַּבּוּל (בראשית רבה),

Rashi on Genesis 10:21) should not reach the punishable age before the Flood.

דִּכְתִיב כִּי הַנַּעַר בֶּן מֵאָה שָׁנָה יָמוּת (ישעיהו ס"ה) רָאוּי לְעָנְשׁ לֶעָתִיד, וְכֵן לִפְנֵי מַתַּן תּוֹרָה:

For it is written (Isaiah 65:20), "For as a lad shall one die when he is one hundred years old", meaning, that in the future time, he will only then be of punishable age, and this was so, too, before the giving of the Torah (Genesis Rabbah 26:2) .

את שם את חם ואת יפת.

וַהֲלֹא יֶפֶת הַגָּדוֹל הוּא? אֶלָּא בַּתְּחִלָּה אַתָּה דוֹרֵשׁ אֶת שֶׁהוּא צַדִּיק וְנוֹלַד כְּשֶׁהוּא מָהוּל וְשֶׁאַבְרָהָם יָצָא מִמֶּנּוּ וְכוּ' בבראשית רבה:

את שם ואת חם ואת יפת *SHEM, HAM AND JAPHETH — But was not Japheth the eldest?*

But you naturally first interest yourself in Shem who was a righteous man, who was born circumcised (a sign of righteousness) and from whom Abraham was to descend (Genesis Rabbah 26:3).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT BERESHIT

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בני האלקים.

בְּנֵי הַשָּׂרִים וְהַשּׁוֹפְטִים. דָּבָר אַחֵר בְּנֵי הָאֱלֹקִים,

בני האלקים *THE SONS OF ELOHIM — The sons of princes and rulers (Genesis Rabbah 26:15).*

הֵם הַשָּׂרִים הַהוֹלְכִים בִּשְׁלִיחוּתוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם, אַף הֵם הָיוּ מִתְעָרְבִים בָּהֶם; כָּל אֱלֹקִים שֶׁמַּמְקְרָא לְשׁוֹן מָרוּת,

Another explanation of בני האלקים *is that these were princely angels who came as messengers from God:*

they, too, intermingled with them (the daughters of men).

וְזֶה יוֹכִיחַ וְאַתָּה תִּהְיֶה לּוֹ לֵאלֹקִים (שמות ד'), רְאֵה נְתַתִּיךָ אֱלֹקִים (שם ז'):

Wherever the word אלקים *occurs in the Scriptures it signifies authority, and the following passages prove this:*

*(Exodus 4:16) "and thou shalt be his (*אלקים*) master", and (Exodus 7:1) "See, I have made the (*אלקים*) a master."*

כי טבת הנה.

אָמַר רַבִּי יוּדָן טבת כְּתִיב, כְּשֶׁהָיוּ מְטִיבִין אוֹתָהּ מְקֻשֶּׁטֶת לִכָּנֵס לַחֻפָּה,

הָיָה גָּדוֹל נִכְנָס וּבוֹעֲלָהּ תְּחִלָּה (בראשית רבה):

כי טבת הנה *THAT THEY WERE FAIR — Rabbi Judan said, "It is written here* טבת*, for when they were being made to appear "good" by being decked out to be taken beneath the marriage canopy one of the lords would come and carry her off first (Genesis Rabbah 26:5).*

מכל אשר בחרו.

אַף בְּעוּלַת בַּעַל, אַף הַזָּכָר וְהַבְּהֵמָה:

מכל אשר בחרו *OF ALL WHOM THEY CHOOSE — even if it were a married woman or a man or an animal (Genesis Rabbah 26:5).*

לא ידון רוחי באדם.

לֹא יִתְרַעֵם וְיָרִיב רוּחִי עָלַי בִּשְׁבִיל הָאָדָם

לא ידון רוחי באדם *MY SPIRIT SHALL NOT STRIVE AGAINST MAN — My Spirit shall not be in a state of discontent and shall not strive with Myself because of man.*

לעלם.

לְאֹרֶךְ יָמִים; הִנֵּה רוּחִי נָדוֹן בְּקִרְבִּי אִם לְהַשְׁחִית וְאִם לְרַחֵם, לֹא יִהְיֶה מָדוֹן זֶה בְּרוּחִי לְעוֹלָם, כְּלוֹמַר לְאֹרֶךְ יָמִים:

לעולם *ALWAYS — for a long time.*

Behold, My Spirit has been contending within Me whether to destroy or whether to show mercy:

such contending (deliberation) shall not be forever — meaning, for a long time.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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בשגם הוא בשר.

כְּמוֹ בְּשֶׁגַּם, כְּלוֹמַר, בִּשְׁבִיל שֶׁגַּם זֹאת בּוֹ,

בשגם הוא בשר *FOR THAT HE ALSO IS FLESH — This is the same as* בשגם *— that is to say:*

שֶׁהוּא בָּשָׂר וְאַף עַל פִּי כֵן אֵינוֹ נִכְנָע לְפָנַי, וּמָה אִם יִהְיֶה אֵשׁ אוֹ דָּבָר קָשֶׁה?

because this quality is also in him viz., that he is only flesh, and yet he does not humble himself before Me;

what would he do if he were of fire or of some other resisting matter!

כַּיּוֹצֵא בּוֹ עַד שַׁקַּמְתִּי דְּבוֹרָה (שופטים ה') כְּמוֹ שֶׁקַּמְתִּי וְכֵן שְׁאַתָּה מְדַבֵּר עִמִּי (שם ו') כְּמוֹ שֶׁאַתָּה, אַף בְּשַׁגַּם כְּמוֹ בְּשֶׁגַּם;

Similarly we find ש *for* שׁ*, (Judges 5:7)* עד שקמתי דבורה *"Until I Deborah arose", where it is the same as* שקמתי*;*

so also (Judges 6:17) שאתה מדבר עמי *"that it is thou who talkest with me", where it is the same as* שאתה *— so also here.*

והיו ימיו וגו'.

עַד ק"ך שָׁנָה אַאֲרִיךְ לָהֶם אַפִּי, וְאִם לֹא יָשׁוּבוּ אָבִיא עֲלֵיהֶם מַבּוּל.

וְאִם תֹּאמַר מִשֶּׁנּוֹלַד יֶפֶת עַד הַמַּבּוּל אֵינוֹ אֶלָּא מֵאָה שָׁנָה,

והיו ימיו וגו *THEREFORE HIS DAYS SHALL BE etc. — For 120 years I will be long-suffering with them, and if they repent not I shall bring a flood upon them.*

אֵין מֻקְדָּם וּמְאֻחָר בַּתּוֹרָה (פסחים ו')

If, now, you object, saying that from the birth of Japheth until the Flood there were only 100 years, remember that there is no "earlier" or "later" in the Torah (events are not always related in chronological order) (Pesachim 6b):

כְּבָר הָיְתָה הַגְּזֵרָה עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה קֹדֶם שֶׁהוֹלִיד נֹחַ תּוֹלְדוֹת, וְכֵן מָצִינוּ בְּסֵדֶר עוֹלָם.

the decree (regarding the Flood) was issued twenty years before Noah had any children — so we find in Seder Olam.

יֵשׁ מִדְרָשֵׁי אַגָּדָה רַבִּים בְּלֹא יָדוֹן, אֲבָל זֶה הוּא צִחְצוּחַ פְּשׁוּטוֹ:

There are many Midrashic explanations of the words לא ידון *but this is transparently its plain sense.*

הנפלים.

עַל שֵׁם שֶׁנָּפְלוּ וְהִפִּילוּ אֶת הָעוֹלָם, וּבְלְשׁוֹן עִבְרִית לְשׁוֹן עֲנָקִים הוּא:

הנפילים *THE GIANTS — Thy were called* נפילים *because they fell (*נפלו*) and caused the downfall of (*הפילו*) the world (Genesis Rabbah 26:7).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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בימים ההם.

בִּימֵי דוֹר אֱנוֹשׁ וּבְנֵי קַיִן (בראשית רבה):

In Hebrew the giants are usually called ענקים. בימים ההם *IN THOSE DAYS — In the days of the generations of Enosh and the sons of Cain (Genesis Rabbah 26:7).*

וגם אחרי כן.

אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁרָאוּ בְּאֻבְדָן שֶׁל דּוֹר אֱנוֹשׁ,

שֶׁעָלָה אוֹקְיָנוּס וְהֵצִיף שְׁלִישׁ הָעוֹלָם לֹא נִכְנַע דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל לִלְמֹד מֵהֶם:

וגם אחרי כן *AND ALSO AFTER THAT — Although they witnessed the destruction of the generation of Enosh when the Ocean rose and flooded a third part of the world, yet the generation of the Flood did not humble itself and take a lesson from them (Genesis Rabbah 26).*

אשר יבאו.

הָיוּ יוֹלְדוֹת עֲנָקִים כְּמוֹתָם:

אשר יבאו *WHEN [THE SONS OF GOD] CAME IN, they (the women) bore children, giants like them (the fathers) (Genesis Rabbah 26:7).*

הגבורים.

לִמְרֹד בַּמָּקוֹם:

הגבורים *MIGHTY — in rebellion against God.*

אנשי השם.

אוֹתָן שֶׁנִּקְבוּ בְּשֵׁמוֹת עִירָד מְחוּיָאֵל מְתוּשָׁאֵל שֶׁנִּקְבוּ עַל שֵׁם אָבְדָן, שֶׁנִּמְחוּ וְהֻתְּשׁוּ. דָּבָר אַחֵר אַנְשֵׁי שֵׁמָמוֹן, שֶׁשִּׁמְּמוּ אֶת הָעוֹלָם:

אנשי שם *MEN OF RENOWN (literally, men of name) — Men who bore distinctive names:* עירד, מחויאל, מתושאל *being so named because these names have reference to their destruction, for they were wiped out and torn out from the world (*אל-מחוי *would signify "wiped-out-by-God",* מתושאל *"Torn-out-by-God).*

*Another explanation is that they were men of devastation (*אנשי שם-מון*) — who devastated the world (Genesis Rabbah 26:7).*

וינחם ה' כי עשה.

נֶחָמָה הָיְתָה לְפָנָיו שֶׁבְּרָאוֹ בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים,

שֶׁאִלּוּ הָיָה מִן הָעֶלְיוֹנִים הָיָה מַמְרִידָן (בבראשית רבה):

וינחם ה' כי עשה *AND THE LORD REPENTED THAT HE HAD MADE — (The first word is connected with that which means "comfort") It was a consolation to Him that He had created man on earth, for had he been one of the heavenly beings he would have incited them also to rebel against God (Genesis Rabbah 27:4).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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ויתעצב.

הָאָדָם אֶל לִבּוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם, עָלָה בְּמַחֲשַׁבְתּוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם לְהַעֲצִיבוֹ, זֶהוּ תַּרְגּוּם אֻנְקְלוֹס. דָּבָר אַחֵר וַיִּנָּחֶם

ויתעצב *GRIEVED HIM — means, in the mind of God man became an object to be troubled (punished):*

it entered God's heart to grieve him.

נֶהְפְּכָה מַחְשַׁבְתּוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם מִמִּדַּת רַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין,

This is how the Targum of Onkelos understands the verse.

Another explanation of verse 6: וינחם *AND [THE LORD] REPENTED — The thoughts of God turned from Divine mercy to Divine justice:*

עָלָה בְּמַחְשָׁבָה לְפָנָיו מַה לַּעֲשׂוֹת בָּאָדָם שֶׁעָשָׂה בָּאָרֶץ,

He considered what to do with man whom He had made on the earth.

Wherever this term is used in the Scripture it means "considering what to do".

וְכֵן כָּל לְשׁוֹן נִחוּם שֶׁבַּמִּקְרָא לְשׁוֹן נִמְלָךְ מַה לַּעֲשׂוֹת,

Examples are:

*(Numbers 23:19) "nor the son of man that He should consider (*ויתנחם*)";*

וּבֶן אָדָם וְיִתְנֶחָם (במדבר כ"ג) וְעַל עֲבָדָיו יִתְנֶחָם (דברים ל"ב) וַיִּנָּחֶם ה' עַל הָרָעָה (שמות ל"ב) נִחַמְתִּי כִּי הִמְלַכְתִּי (שמואל א' ט"ו) כֻּלָּם לְשׁוֹן מַחֲשָׁבָה אַחֶרֶת הֵם:

*(Deuteronomy 32:36) "and reconsider (*ויתנחם*) regarding His servants";*

*(Exodus 32:14) "and the Lord reconsidered (*וינחם*) regarding the evil";*

*(1 Samuel 15:11) "I am reconsidering (*נחמתי*) that I have set up Saul to be king" — all these passages denote a change of mind.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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ויתעצב אל לבו.

נִתְאַבֵּל עַל אָבְדַן מַעֲשֵׂה יָדָיו, כְּמוֹ נֶעֱצַב הַמֶּלֶךְ עַל בְּנוֹ (שם ב' י"ט),

ויתעצב אל לבו *AND IT GRIEVED HIM AT HIS HEART— He mourned at the failure of His handiwork.*

וְזוֹ כָּתַבְתִּי לְתְשׁוּבַת הַמִּינִים גּוֹי אֶחָד שֶׁשָּׁאַל אֶת רַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בֶּן קֶרְחָה,

Similarly (2 Samuel 19:3) 'The king grieved (נעצב) for his son".

אָמַר לוֹ אֵין אַתֶּם מוֹדִים שֶׁהַקָּבָ"ה רוֹאֶה אֶת הַנּוֹלָד? אָמַר לוֹ הֵן,

(Similarly here:

אָמַר לוֹ וְהָא כְתִיב וַיִּתְעַצֵּב אֶל לִבּוֹ? אָמַר לוֹ נוֹלַד לְךָ בֵּן זָכָר מִיָּמֶיךָ? אָמַר לוֹ הֵן, אָמַר לוֹ וּמָה עָשִׂיתָ?

God grieved for his (man's) heart:

אָמַר לוֹ שָׂמַחְתִּי וְשִׂמַּחְתִּי אֶת הַכֹּל,

that it had changed from good to bad).

אָמַר לוֹ וְלֹא הָיִיתָ יוֹדֵעַ שֶׁסּוֹפוֹ לָמוּת?

The following extract from the Midrash Rabbah I am writing in order that you may know how to refute the arguments of certain heretics:

אָמַר לוֹ בְּשָׁעַת חֲדָוָתָא בְּשָׁעַת אֲבֵלָא אֲבֵלָא, אָמַר לוֹ כָּךְ מַעֲשֵׂה הַקָּבָ"ה,

A gentile once asked Rabbi Joshua, the son of Korcha, saying to him, "Do you not admit that the Holy One, blessed be He, knows what is to happen in the future?" He replied, "Yes." The gentile retorted, "But is it not written 'and He was grieved in His heart'?" He answered: "Have you ever had a son born to you?" The reply was "Yes." He asked (the gentile): "And what did you do?" He replied: "I rejoiced and I made others rejoice also." The Rabbi asked him: "But did you not know that he must die?" The heathen replied: "At the time of joy, let there be joy, at the time of mourning let there be mourning".

אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁגָּלוּי לְפָנָיו שֶׁסּוֹפָן לַחֲטוֹא וּלְאָבְדָן לֹא נִמְנַע מִלְּבָרְאָן בִּשְׁבִיל הַצַּדִּיקִים הָעֲתִידִים לֵעָמֹד מֵהֶם:

The Rabbi then said: "Such, too, is the way of the Holy One, blessed be He:

although it was clear to Him that in the end men would sin and would be destroyed, He did not refrain from creating them for the sake of the righteous men who were to issue from them" (Genesis Rabbah 27:4).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

Thresholds of life, from the womb to the flood

Saturday, 10 October 2026 · Aliyah 7/7 (Genesis 5:25-6:8) · Daf Bekhorot 22

ויאמר ה' אמחה את האדם.

הוּא עָפָר וְאָבִיא עָלָיו מַיִם וְאֶמְחֶה אוֹתוֹ, לְכָךְ נֶאֱמַר לָשׁוֹן מְחוּי:

ויאמר ה' אמחה את האדם *AND GOD SAID I WILL BLOT OUT THE MAN — He is dust and I shall bring water upon him and blot him out:*

that is why this root מחה *is used (it expresses the idea of sponging out by means of wet or dampness) (Genesis Rabbah 28:2).*

מאדם עד בהמה.

אַף הֵם הִשְׁחִיתוּ דַּרְכָּם (בראשית רבה). דִּבָּר אַחֵר הַכֹּל נִבְרָא בִּשְׁבִיל אָדָם וְכֵיוָן שֶׁהוּא כָּלֶה מַה צֹּרֶךְ בְּאֵלּוּ:

מאדם ועד בהמה *— FROM MAN, TO BEAST — These also corrupted their way (Genesis Rabbah 28:8).*

Another explanation is:

All things were created on man's account;

when he ceases to be, what need of them?

(Sanhedrin 108a)

כי נחמתי כי עשיתם.

חָשַׁבְתִּי מַה לַּעֲשׂוֹת עַל אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִים:

כי נחמתי כי עשיתים *means for I have thought out what to do because I have made them.*

(Cf.

this with Rashi's second explanation of וינחם *5:6).*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Midrash in, peshat out

On 'the sons of Elohim' (6:2), Rashi offers the midrashic menu straight from Bereshit Rabbah 26:5 — 'sons of princes and rulers,' with 'another explanation' following — but he compresses three rabbinic opinions into a single breath, unattributed, as if they were his own reading. The midrash is the quarry; the comment is the cut stone.

On 'My spirit shall not strive' (6:3), Rashi leans on Seder Olam Rabbah 28 for the 120-year countdown — a chronological tradition smuggled into a theological verse. He quotes the source's arithmetic (120 years of forbearance) but drops its framework, letting the number do peshat work: God's patience has a deadline.

On Noah's naming (5:29), 'this will comfort us' — Rashi takes the Tanchuma's etymology (בן from בנה, 'to build': from him the world was built up) and makes it do double duty as both philology and theology. The wordplay is the comfort.

WORD STUDIES

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Three words from the aliyah

Three load-bearing words from the closing aliyah of Bereshit — a measure of time, the divine name at its most intimate, and the verb that carries the genealogy. Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria (CAL prohibits scraping).

שָׁנָה

Klein · שנה

f.n.

— (dual שנתים, pl. שנים) year.

Jastrow · שינה

f.

— sleep. Ber. 3ᵇ מעולם לא עבר ... בש׳ midnight never found me asleep. Ib. 62ᵇ ש׳ בעמוד וכ׳ sleep at morning dawn (v. שינא I). Meg. 15ᵇ שנת וכ׳, v. נדד. Succ. 26ᵃ שינת, v. עראי. Ib. במוסר שינתו וכ׳ when he g

Jastrow · שנה

שנה — 'year.' First seen as the unit of the genealogies: 'and all the days of Methuselah were nine hundred sixty-nine years.' The word travels from time-measure to the anniversary cycle (שנה בשנה), to the Mishnaic ראש השנה, and lands in modern Hebrew as the plain word for year — but also, by a second root, 'to repeat, to learn' (שנה, the shnayim mikra practice itself is built on it). In this aliyah it is the drumbeat of mortality: every life summed in years, every verse ending 'and he died.'

יְהוָה

Klein · יהוה

m.n.

— the proper name of God in the Bible, Tetragrammaton.

BDB · יהוה

— 6823 i.e. יהוה n.pr.dei Yahweh, the proper name of the God of Israel—(1. MT יהוה6518 (Qr אדני), or יהוה305 (Qr אלקים), in the combinations יהוה אדני & אדני יהוה (vid. אדני), and with prep. ביהוה, ל

BDB · יהוה²

— n.pr.dei, v. sub הוה p. 217 ff.

יהוה — the Tetragrammaton. First seen in Genesis 2:4, but here in 6:3-8 it appears at the flood's threshold — 'My spirit shall not strive,' 'I will blot out,' 'Noah found favor in the eyes of יהוה.' The name travels from the garden's intimacy through prophetic judgment-speech to the liturgical unpronounceable, and lands in this aliyah doing what it does at every crisis: marking the personal God who regrets, resolves, and singles out one man. What the arc reveals here is the name's narrative function — it is always יהוה who sees, who grieves, who saves.

יוֹלֶד

Jastrow · ילד

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Jastrow · יולד

m. pl.

— יולדים (b. h.; parents. Keth. VII, 6 המקללת יולדיו בפניו she who curses his (her husband's) parents in his presence; quot. ib. 72ᵇ יולידיו (an emphatic form), and interpreted במקללת יולידיו בפני מולידיו (v

BDB · ילד

— vb. bear, bring forth, beget (NH id.; Aramaic יליד, ילד, ; Arabic bear, bring forth, so Ethiopic Assyrian alâdu, COTGloss)—

ויולד — 'and he begot.' The hiphil of ילד, first seen in Genesis 4:18 and repeated like a hammer through chapter 5: ויולד, ויולד, ויולד. Klein traces ילד to the birthing act; Jastrow shows the hiphil as the causative — to cause to be born, to father. It travels from genealogy-formula to the legal language of descent (מוליד), and lands in modern Hebrew as the ordinary verb for fathering. In this aliyah it is the engine of the text — the repeated ויולד is what makes the genealogy a genealogy, each begetting a small creation, until Noah, whose begetting the text pointedly delays to age five hundred.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr